

corrupted hosts operating systems in the past when we tried to install both of them on a single machine. This happened with both, Windows and Linux (we noticed Ubuntu 10.10 and openSUSE 11.2 crashing). We don't recommend installing both virtualization software at once.

Creating a new virtual machine

Once you've installed and configured VirtualBox correctly, you can click on the "New" button on its main window to get started. The following would start happening:

- ▶ A window would come up saying that the wizard will guide you through the creation of a new virtual machine and so on. Click "next" to continue.
- ▶ VirtualBox will ask you the name and the "type" of operating system you intend to use the virtual machine for. The "type" is actually the OS family (such as "Windows" or "Linux") and version / distribution (e.g. "Windows XP", "Fedora") of the OS. Just start typing the name of the OS in the box provided and if what you type matches with the name and edition of a supported guest OS then VirtualBox will automatically choose the right match for you. For example, try typing "Ubuntu" as the name and the OS type automatically changes to "Linux" and the version changes to "Ubuntu". Intuitive, isn't it? Click "next".
- ▶ VirtualBox will now ask you to decide on the capacity of RAM you want to allocate to the OS. Depending on the family and the version of the operating system you selected in the previous step, VirtualBox tries to make a wise decision. For example, if you've selected "Windows" / "Windows XP" as the family / version of the OS, VirtualBox will set the RAM capacity by default to 192 MB. If you select "Windows" / "Windows 7", it sets the default to 512 MB. Remember that these are the defaults the VirtualBox has set for you. Since you're the master here, you must decide what feats you want to perform in the virtual machine and set the desired RAM allocation accordingly.
- ▶ In this step, you've to decide whether you want to use a hard disk or not. Well, you can use the virtual machine without one! If you've ever used a live Linux system (like ubuntu) which doesn't make use of the hard disk, you'd know! In most cases you're going to use a hard disk. You'll have the option to create a new one or use another existing one. If you're trying to make use of a virtual hard disk file which you copied from somewhere, you can select the "Use existing hard disk" and click on the browse button to locate it and use it. By default VirtualBox will